



BIXXVILLE OS · CANON RECORD

The Language of the Network

The unedited historical and linguistic baseline for the internal working language of the Bixxville network.

BXV-LANG-000 · Record only, no decisions adopted

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SECTION 0

Purpose and Standing of This Document

This document enters into Bixxville canon the **unedited historical record** of the language selected as the basis for the language of the network.

It records what the source materials actually say. It does **not** adopt, normalize, correct, standardize, or coin anything. Where the historical record is inconsistent, the inconsistency is preserved here rather than resolved.

This is deliberate. Every future decision about the network language — its name, its spelling, its new vocabulary — must be traceable back to an unmodified baseline. This document is that baseline.

STANDING

Nothing in this document is a Bixxville decision. Open decisions are listed in Section 9 and remain open.

Amendment rule: this document is append-only. Corrections are added as dated notes; nothing is deleted.

SECTION 1

Source of Record

1.1 Primary source supplied to canon

Cefas van Rossem & Hein van der Voort (eds.), *Die Creol taal: 250 Years of Negerhollands Texts*. Amsterdam University Press, Amsterdam, 1996. 357 pp. Introduction edited by Pieter Muysken. Digital edition via DBNL (*Digitale Bibliotheek voor de Nederlandse Letteren*), 2007.

1.2 Composition of the source

1. A linguistic and historical introduction
2. An anthology of texts spanning roughly 1736 to the 1930s, presented in *diplomatic edition* — meaning the editors reproduced the original manuscripts exactly, including spelling errors, corrections, and marginal additions, without silently fixing anything
3. An annotated bibliography of known manuscripts and publications in and about the language

1.3 Origin of the source

The book grew out of a database project (September 1991 – December 1993) run at the University of Amsterdam, in which roughly 2,000 manuscript pages and 500 printed pages were transcribed. The

manuscripts were rediscovered by Peter Stein in the Moravian archives at Herrnhut, Germany, and were in a state of physical decay; they were microfilmed for preservation.

1.4 Rights position — recorded for compliance

- A **language** is not copyrightable. Its grammar, phonology, word forms, and historical vocabulary are facts and are free to use.
- The **source book's editorial apparatus** — the editors' glosses, translations, footnotes, commentary, and the arrangement of the anthology — is © 1996 Amsterdam University Press / © 2007 DBNL.
- **Bixxville's position:** we extract the linguistic system and build our own lexicon, grammar reference, and coinages. We do not reprint the book's editorial matter. The source is cited in the front matter of every Bixxville publication in this language.

SECTION 2

Identification of the Language

2.1 What it is

A **creole** language with a predominantly Dutch lexicon, spoken in the Virgin Islands (St. Thomas, St. John, St. Croix) from roughly 1700 until the late 20th century. Now extinct.

A creole is a language born from contact — formed when people with no shared language are forced together and their children grow up speaking the new system natively. Creoles are not corrupted versions of European languages; they take vocabulary from one source and structure from elsewhere, and function as complete languages in their own right.

This one was created by locally-born enslaved Africans on Danish-held, Dutch-planter-dominated St. Thomas. Its vocabulary is mostly Dutch — specifically Zealandic and West Flemish dialects, not standard Dutch — with significant Portuguese, Spanish, English, Danish, and German elements, and grammatical structures traced to West African languages.

OF RECORD

It was the first language on earth to be called a creole, in 1736.

2.2 What it is not

It is not the indigenous language of St. Croix. The pre-contact language of St. Croix was Taíno. The Taíno of St. Croix were destroyed by genocide and epidemics following 1493. This language postdates that by two centuries and has no relation to it.

It is not Dutch. The 1777 missionary Oldendorp argued it was merely mutilated Dutch. That view was contested from at least 1810 (Rask) and is now rejected. The grammar is structurally different from Dutch in word order, verb system, article system, and possession.

It is not Crucian. Modern Crucian is an English-lexicon creole, a separate language that displaced this one on St. Croix.

2.3 Recorded names — unedited

NAME	SOURCE AND STANDING
die Creol taal	Negerhollands for "the Creole language." Used by 18th-c. Danish and German missionaries. The source book's title.
die Creol spraak	Alternate 18th-c. missionary form, same meaning
die how Creol	Negerhollands for "the old Creole" — recorded as what native Virgin Islanders themselves called it, meaning the language of former days, no longer spoken
Carriolse	The 1736 form. First recorded use of "creole" for a language, anywhere
Negerhollands	Dutch scholarly coinage, christened by van den Bergh in 1840, built on the pattern of Neger-Engels and Neger-Frans. Standard in academic literature. Not a speaker term.
Creole Dutch	Common in English-language scholarship
Virgin Islands Dutch Creole	Common in English-language scholarship

NOTE FOR CANON

"Negerhollands" carries a slur root and is a colonial academic label, not a name the speakers used. It is recorded here because it is the term under which all research is indexed and findable. Whether Bixxville uses it, uses a speaker term, or coins its own name is an open decision (Section 9).

2.4 St. Croix — recorded qualification

The source states plainly that this language was used **considerably less on St. Croix** than on St. Thomas and St. John. St. Croix was purchased by Denmark from France in 1733; by 1741 there were five times as many English on the island as Danes, and an English-lexicon creole emerged there instead.

The Moravian missionary Auerbach recorded in 1774 that on St. Croix more black residents understood English than on St. Thomas and St. John, and that their English speech was heavily mixed with the Creole and Guinea languages — he called the result "Negro-English."

A small number of creole slave letters from St. Croix do survive and are included in the anthology.

QUALIFICATION ON CANON CLAIMS

This is recorded as a factual qualification on any claim that this is "the language of St. Croix." It is the language of the Danish Virgin Islands, documented most heavily on St. Thomas and St. John, present on St. Croix, and displaced there earliest.

SECTION 3

Historical Record

YEAR	EVENT
1493	Columbus names the Virgin Islands; encounters Taíno on St. Croix
—	St. Croix Taíno destroyed by genocide and epidemic disease
1600s	European settlement and importation of enslaved Africans begins
1653	Danish West-Indian Company founded
1665	First Danish attempt to settle St. Thomas — fails
1666	English raiding of the Dutch Windward Antilles; Dutch planters flee St. Eustatius for St. Thomas, possibly carrying an existing Dutch pidgin or creole
1671	Danish West-Indian Company obtains monopoly over St. Thomas
1672	Danish colonization of St. Thomas proper begins — 113 inhabitants
1672–1739	Formative period. Majority of imported enslaved people are Twi-speaking Akan; Ewe speakers hypothesized as the strongest African lexical influence
1688	First official census, St. Thomas: 422 enslaved, 317 white. Households: 66 Dutch, 32 English, 20 Danish, 8 French, 3 German, 3 Swedish, 1 Holstein, 1 Portuguese
1692	One fifth of the enslaved population is already St. Thomas-born
~1700	The language emerges as a distinct system
1717	St. John comes under Danish occupation
1721	25 of 39 planters on St. John are Dutch; 9 are Danish. The language is reported in use there
1725	Enslaved population of St. Thomas reaches 4,490
1733	Denmark buys St. Croix from France. Moravian settlers arrive; many die of disease
1736	Earliest manuscript evidence. First called <i>Carriolse</i> — the first language ever called "creole"
1739	First dictated letters in the creole appear
1741	Five times as many English as Danes on St. Croix
1765	First printed booklet in the language — independent status acknowledged by the Moravians

YEAR	EVENT
1770	J.M. Magens publishes his 80-page grammar in Danish — the first printed grammar of any creole language on earth
1774	Auerbach's account of the three-island language situation
1777	Oldendorp publishes his Moravian mission history containing a grammatical sketch
1802	A further Moravian missionary grammar written — never published
~1810	Danish linguist R.K. Rask contrasts it with Greenlandic Inuit; argues against Adelung's 1809 "corrupted Dutch" claim
1840	van den Bergh coins the term "Negerhollands"
1869–70	Van Name compares it with Papiamentu, Trinidad French Creole, and Sranan
1881	E. Pontoppidan's study
1883	A. Magens writes to Hugo Schuchardt in the language and supplies proverbs
1905	D.C. Hesseling publishes <i>Het Negerhollandsch der Deense Antillen</i> — first anthology and comprehensive historical study
1914	Schuchardt's commentary
1917	The Danish West Indies are transferred to the United States
1922–23	J.P.B. de Josselin de Jong conducts fieldwork; collects folk tales and a large word list
1926	de Josselin de Jong publishes the collected stories
1936	F.G. Nelson collects field notes on St. Thomas: a 7-page word list of 413 items plus short texts. Unpublished until 1996
1980–87	G.A. Sprauve and R. Sabino record Mrs. Alice Stevens, the last fluent speaker
1991–93	Amsterdam database project transcribes ~2,000 manuscript pages
1996	<i>Die Creol taal</i> published
Late 20th c.	The language is extinct

SECTION 4

Documentary Base

The full body of surviving material, as recorded in the source.

18TH CENTURY

- Moravian Brethren manuscripts, Herrnhut archive (from 1736) — the bulk of the material
- Magens 1770 grammar — Danish-language, Latin-grammar model, rich in proverbs and everyday speech fragments
- Oldendorp 1777 — printed grammatical sketch; fuller grammar survives in manuscript
- Kingo 1770 and Wold 1770 — Danish ABC/primer booklets
- Slave letters, from 1739 — dictated, including a small number from St. Croix
- Hymnals, New and Old Testament translations, catechisms, liturgical texts

19TH CENTURY

- The 1802 unpublished Moravian grammar
- Correspondence and proverbs collected via Schuchardt

20TH CENTURY

- de Josselin de Jong 1922/23 — folk tales, glossary, word list
- Nelson 1936 — 413-item word list and short texts
- Sprauve and Sabino recordings of Alice Stevens, 1980–87

RECORDED BIAS IN THE MATERIAL

The source is explicit that the surviving corpus over-represents the **acrolect** — the register closest to European Dutch, used by whites and missionaries — and under-represents the **basilect**, the language as actually spoken by field labourers. Nearly all surviving text was written by missionaries or dictated to them. The 20th-century recordings are the closest we have to the unmediated spoken language.

Oldendorp himself acknowledged that he and the missionaries wrote an idealized variety that leaned toward Dutch.

SECTION 5

The Grammar as Documented

Recorded unedited. Spelling variants are preserved as they appear in the sources.

5.1 Word order

Fixed: **Subject — Negation — Verb complex — Complement.**

No inversion. The order does not change for questions, for subordinate clauses, or after adverbs. This is a direct structural break from Dutch, which places the auxiliary second and the main verb at the end.

Attested (Magens 1770):

Pampuen no kan parie Kalbas
pumpkin NEG can give.birth calabash

"A pumpkin cannot give birth to a calabash."

5.2 Verbs — no inflection

The verb does not change form. Tense, mood, and aspect are carried by separate preverbal particles.

PARTICLE	FUNCTION	ORIGIN
a	past	Dutch
ha	past (18th c. variant)	Du. <i>had</i> , or a dialectal infinitive of "have"
ka, kabba	perfective — completed action	Port./Sp. <i>acabar</i> "to finish"
sa, sal	future	Du. <i>zal</i>
lo	progressive; also near-future; also modality	Du. <i>loop</i> "walk"
le	habitual / durative (older form)	possibly Du. <i>leggen</i> "lay"
no	negation	English or Spanish; Spanish more probable
da	emphatic / focus marker	—

Particles stack. **a ka** = past + completed.

Attested (de Josselin de Jong, early 20th c.):

Am a ko a hus.
3SG PST come NA house
"He came home."

mi sa wis ju wapi ju kaa trou een
1SG FUT show 2SG where 2SG PRF marry a
"I will show you where you married one."

RECORDED INSTABILITY

le was gradually replaced by lo as durative marker, complete by the early 1800s. Because lo retained its verbal sense "go," it came to be used ambiguously as progressive *and* near-future, competing with the older future marker sa(l). The source flags this as unresolved.

Attested triple use of lo (1926):

am fo lo a hus lo du wa bin da lo wak fo am.
3SG FOR go NA house go do what be there go wait FOR 3SG
"He has to go home to do what is waiting there for him."

5.3 Articles, determiners, gender

- One invariant article: **die**. Also functions as "that," "it," and "which" — the source describes it as carrying the general notion of determination
- Demonstrative: **deese**
- **No grammatical gender**
- Generic nouns, common in proverbs, take no article at all

5.4 Possession

Possessor + possessive particle + thing. The possessive is invariant — the same form for his, her, its.

si / sie / shi (< Du. masc. sg. *zijn*)

Dootman sie Door
dead.man 3POS door
"the dead man's door"

Hunder wil si Kikkentje alteveel
chicken want 3POS chick all.too.much
"She loves her children."

This construction — possessor fronted, resumptive possessive particle — is shared across Caribbean creoles and is attributed to West African substrate grammar, not Dutch.

5.5 Pronouns

	SINGULAR	PLURAL (STANDARD)	PLURAL (-LIE VARIANT)
1st	mi, mie, mij	ons	wellie
2nd	ju, joe	jender	jellie, jelli
3rd	am, hem	sender	sellie, selli, sel

Recorded properties:

- One form serves subject, object, and possessive. **mi** = I, me, my
- No gender in the third person. **am** = he, she, it, him, her
- The forms derive from Dutch **non-subject** forms (Du. *mij, hem*) used in subject position
- **ju** traces to West Germanic /u/ via Zeelandic Dutch, not to English

RECORDED INSTABILITY

Magens 1770 gives two plural sets. The **-lie** forms (< Du. *lieden* "people") appear only in the nominative and vocative; elsewhere **ons** / **jender** / **sender** are used. The 1802 Moravian grammar and Oldendorp assign the **-lie** forms to a single unnamed dialect and only for reference to persons. The editors suspect they were characteristic of white speech. By the 20th century only **sel** survives, and rarely.

5.6 Plural

Marked by the postposed particle **sender** — identical in form to the third person plural pronoun.

die kind sender
DET child 3PL
"the children"

RECORDED INSTABILITY

Analytic and synthetic plurals coexisted freely, sometimes in the same sentence: **die kind sender** alongside **die kinders**. The **-s** ending reflects Dutch and correlates with white speech.

5.7 Comparison

Analytic. No endings.

FORM	MEANING
klein	small
meer klein	smaller
meest klein	smallest
alteveel klein	the very smallest

Two irregular sets survive from Dutch: **guut – beeter – best** and **veel – meer – meest**.

RECORDED EXCEPTIONS

A **-ste** superlative occurs (**die mooiste** "the handsomest") but Mogens ascribes it mostly to whites. In 20th-c. material only **me:**, **me:stə**, **be:tə(r)**, **bes**, one **-ste** form (**gro:stə**), and two anglicized forms (**hogis**, **di langis**) appear. The source flags this as needing further research.

5.8 Prepositions

na is the all-purpose locative preposition: in, at, to, on. Probably from Port. *na* (< *em a*), reinforced by older Du. *naar*.

Compounds with a second element for precision: **nabin** (**na** + **in**) "inside."

Other recorded items: **vor / vo / fo / for** (complementizer and purposive: "for, in order to"), **met** (with), **van** (of, from), **sonder** (without), **tee** (until – probably Port. *até*), **op** (on).

R-pronouns absent. Dutch *daar* and *waar* in their pronominal function did not transfer.

5.9 Serial verbs

Two verbs in sequence with a single subject, where the object of the first is the instrument of the second.

mi neem Steen veeg mi Hogo
1SG take stone wipe 1SG eye
"I wipe my eyes with a stone."

Attributed to West African grammar. The source notes serial constructions are not frequent in the earlier material but are attested.

5.10 Verbs derived from particles

Particles could be reinterpreted as verbs — something Dutch does not do. **yt** ("out") functions as a verb meaning "go out":

```
Als die Vier ka yt
when DET fire PRF out
"When the fire has gone out"
```

The source identifies this reinterpretation as characteristic of the creole-to-lexifier relationship generally.

5.11 Shifted argument structure

Dutch verbs acquired syntactic properties they do not have in Dutch. **jammer** ("bewail") and **kries** ("cry") take direct human objects:

```
Mie jammer Ju tee mie kries Ju
1SG bewail 2SG till 1SG cry 2SG
"I pity you to the point of crying for you."
```

wil (< Du. *willen* "want") is used for "love" — Hesseling 1933 attributes this to Papiamentu influence, since Ibero-Romance *querer* means both.

5.12 Passive

Rare. Magens 1770 states it was used only occasionally and that progressive passives were avoided; where it occurred it was mostly white speech.

Auxiliaries: **wort** and **bin**. **bin** is present tense; other tenses use the infinitive **wees** plus a tense particle. **wort** combines with a Dutch past participle.

```
Mie bin vervolgt. / Mie wort vervolgt.
"I am persecuted."

Christus ha wort gebooren of die Maegt Maria
"Christ was born of the Virgin Mary"
```

That last example is recorded as notable: Dutch morphosyntax combined with the creole tense particle **ha**.

Recorded change. By the 20th century the **wort** passive is gone; only **ka** remains.

5.13 Diminutives

Formed analytically with **klein** ("little"): **die klein Kabaj** "the little horse."

The Dutch ending **-tje** was also available (**Mie Montje** "my little mouth") but Magens ascribes it mostly to whites. Also **kleentje** "child."

Recorded change. By the 20th century productive diminutives are gone. Only petrified forms survive: **hofi** "garden," **kalfi** "calf."

5.14 Phonology — recorded features

- **Lexifier is Zealandic Dutch**, with West Flemish influence — not standard Dutch. Hollandic/Standard Dutch appears as a later, secondary target, concentrated in vocabulary of town, harbour, education, and religion
- **Devoicing rule:** initial /z/ → /s/, /v/ → /f/. Hence **see** "say" (< Du. *zeggen*), **for** (< Du. *voor*), **sondo** "sin." Later borrowings resist the rule (**ze:** "sea," **zil** "soul," **venstu** "window")
- **/r/ deletion**, particularly syllable-final. Documented for enslaved speakers by Magens 1770 and fully present in the 1926 and 1936 material
- **Consonant cluster reduction**, same attribution and same continuity
- **Epithetic vowels** — extra vowels inserted to produce an easy CVCV syllable pattern: **hogo** "eye"
- **Marked vowels replaced.** Dutch /ø:/ → /e:/ — **deer** for Du. *deur* "door"
- **Zealandic /y/ unrounded to /i/** in the 20th century; still present as a variant in the 18th, written <y> or <ye> in Danish texts. Probably a high-register marker while field labourers already used /i/

5.15 Attested spelling variation

Recorded, not resolved:

MEANING	ATTESTED FORMS
3rd sg. possessive	si · sie · shi
2nd sg. pronoun	ju · joe · jou
perfective	ka · kaa
house	Hoes · hus
door	Deer · Door · do:
good	goe · guut
for	vor · vo · fo · for
say	see · se:
go	lo · lō

Oldendorp argued explicitly for using **Dutch orthography** on the grounds that black readers were being taught to read in Dutch, that the spelling was already established in the creole hymnal, and that a written language requires a fixed and unchanging basis — particularly consistent vowels.

OF RECORD

This is the earliest recorded argument for standardizing the language's spelling. It is recorded here; no Bixxville spelling decision follows from it.

SECTION 6

Registers and Social Variation

The source documents a stratified language, not a uniform one.

- **"High creole"** — spoken among whites, closer to Dutch, retaining Dutch endings, passives, diminutives, and the **-lie** pronoun set
- **Slave / plantation creole** — the basilect; /r/ deletion, cluster reduction, analytic constructions throughout
- **Guinea-mixed speech** — Oldendorp records that recently-arrived Africans, particularly older ones, spoke the creole mixed with African languages or with heavy African pronunciation, sometimes requiring an interpreter even for fluent creole speakers
- **Liturgical / missionary register** — the register most of the written corpus is in
- **Town vs. plantation** — Auerbach 1774 records that town residents picked up some Dutch from daily contact with whites, while plantation labourers did not

Recorded direction of change. Over time the language *focussed*: the high acrolectal variants disappeared and the basilectal variants survived. The 20th-century material represents the language after that process was complete. The source's working hypothesis is that what we have from 1900 onward is the stabilized slave language.

OF RECORD

Oldendorp also recorded — in the manuscript, not the published book — that speakers did not all like speaking it with whites, because it was at the same time the language of the enslaved.

SECTION 7

Attested Lexicon — Initial Extract

Recorded as they appear, with spelling variation intact. This is a working extract from the source, not a complete lexicon. The full corpus includes Nelson's 413-item list, de Josselin de Jong's glossary, a 338-entry Danish-creole word list, and the whole anthology.

7.1 Function words

FORM	MEANING	FORM	MEANING
die	the, that, it, which	soo	so
deese	this, these	ook / ookal	also
een	a, one	maski	even if, although
si / sie / shi	his, her, its	wapi	where
na	in, at, to, on	wat / wa	what
vor / fo / for	for, in order to	well	well, indeed
met	with	altoeveel	all too much, very
van	of, from	moeschi / muschi	very, much
sonder	without	meer / meest	more / most
tee	until	nu / noe	now
op	on	toen	then
en	and	wanneer	when
of	or	as	if, when, as
maar	but	dat	that

7.2 Verbs

FORM	MEANING	FORM	MEANING
wees / bin / ben / mi	to be	skriev	write
hab	have	verstaan	understand

FORM	MEANING	FORM	MEANING
kan	can	sing	sing
kom / ko	come	help	help
lo / lō	go	sett	sit
doe / du	do	jump	jump
maak / mak	make	gruj	grow
neem / nē	take	dans	dance
see / se:	say	trou	marry
hoor	hear	veeg	wipe
kik / ki	see, look	kries	cry
weet / wet	know	jammer	bewail, pity
gloo	believe	parie	give birth to
wis	show	wil	want; love
wak	wait	vind	find
lees	read	breng	bring
leer	learn, teach	yt	go out

7.3 Nouns

FORM	MEANING	FORM	MEANING
Hoes / hus	house	Wato	water
Deer / Door	door	Steen	stone
Hogo	eye	Gras	grass
Kop / kōp	head	hofi	garden
Han	hand	kot	cabin
Hert	heart	Kabaj	horse
Ziel / zil	soul	kalfi	calf
Kint / kind	child	Hunder	chicken

FORM	MEANING	FORM	MEANING
kleentje	child	Kikkentje	chick
Jung	boy	Branmier	ant
Man	man	Malassie	molasses
Volk / folok	people	Pampuen	pumpkin
shishi	sister	Kalbas	calabash
Dootman	dead man	berri	berry
Taal	language	Vier	fire
Boeki	book	Hassesje	ashes
Brief	letter	Nodh	need, distress
Dag	day	Pien	pain
Werk	work	Sondo / zondə	sin
Stadt	town	Fort	fort

7.4 Attested modifiers

klein (small) · gro (great) · goe / guut (good) · sut (sweet) · frai (nice) · mager (thin) · drung (drunk) · waa (true) · brin (brown) · loi (lazy)

SECTION 8

Attested Texts — Specimens

Included as evidence of what the language looks like across periods. These are proverbs and folk material, not the source book's editorial content.

1770 — PROVERBS, MAGENS

Pampuen no kan parie Kalbas
"A pumpkin cannot give birth to a calabash."

Hogo no hab Deer
"The eye has no door." (= I can't help seeing it.)

Gras le gruj na Dootman sie Door
"Grass grows at the dead man's door."
(= nobody takes care of widows and orphans.)

Hunder wil si Kikkentje alteveel
"The hen loves her chicks all too much."

Branmier val na Malassie, da sut hem ha vind
"The ant fell in the molasses; it was sweetness he found."
(= he got what he deserved.)

1774 — AUERBACH, ON THE LANGUAGE SITUATION

Die hab well twee drie onder die swart Volk, die sender a leer
voor verstaan beetje van die hollandisch Taal, as sender woon
na die Stadt...

"There are indeed two or three among the black people who have
learned to understand a bit of the Dutch language, as they live
in town..."

1926 — FOLK TALE, DE JOSSELIN DE JONG

Am a ko a hus. Am a see a shi shishi, ju kaa trou een man,
am mi een befergi!

"He came home. He said to his sister: you married a man, and
he is a boar pig!"

1936 — NELSON FIELD NOTES, ST. THOMAS

Mi ā lō en dans gistu dūnku. Dē wes drum dans.
Dī folok a wes wel drung.

"I went to a dance last night. It was a drum dance.
The people were well drunk."

SECTION 9

Open Decisions — None Adopted

Recorded for the record. Every item below is **open**.

#	DECISION	STATUS
1	Build approach — revival (documented forms only), extension (documented grammar + newly coined modern vocabulary), or naming layer (English base, creole terms only) RESOLVED — Extension. See Amendment 001.	CLOSED
2	Name of the network language — speaker term, scholarly term, or Bixxville coinage RESOLVED — LOGG. See Amendment 001.	CLOSED
3	Base register — 18th-c. acrolect (best documented), 20th-c. basilect (most authentically the speakers' own), or a defined blend	OPEN
4	Orthography — one spelling per word must be fixed. Dutch-based (per Oldendorp's argument), phonetic, or independent	CLOSED
5	TMA set — le or lo for habitual; how to disambiguate lo progressive from lo future	OPEN
6	Plural — sender particle only, or -s permitted	OPEN
7	Pronoun set — whether the -lie forms are admitted	OPEN
8	Diminutive — analytic klein only, or -tje retained	OPEN
9	Comparison — strict analytic, or -ste permitted	OPEN
10	Word-formation rules for coining new vocabulary — must be written before any coining begins	OPEN
11	Consultation — whether and how to engage Virgin Islands cultural and linguistic authorities before publication	OPEN
12	Bilingual publication standard — how the creole and English versions of Bixxville documents are laid out and which is authoritative	OPEN

SECTION 10

Note on Standing and Stewardship

This language belongs to the cultural heritage of the Virgin Islands. The editors of the source book made that point directly: they chose English as their working language specifically so that Virgin Islanders — who mainly speak English and English Creole — could reach the material.

Bixxville's use of it is an act of stewardship, and stewardship carries obligations. Item 11 in Section 9 is not a formality.

Amendments

This document is append-only. Decisions made after issue are recorded here as dated amendments. The body of the document above is never altered except to cross-reference an amendment.

AMENDMENT 001 · 2026-09-04 UTC

The network language is named LOGG.

Short form: **LOGG**. Full form: **Language of Geb's Guild**. The full form is used on first reference in any published document, in front matter, and anywhere the short form could be mistaken for another canon term.

11.1 What Amendment 001 resolves

ITEM	DECISION	RESOLUTION
9.2	Name of the network language	LOGG — Language of Geb's Guild
9.1	Build approach	Extension — resolved by implication. LOGG is a coinage, not an attested name. Choosing it establishes the method: the documented grammar and attested lexicon are kept intact, and new vocabulary is built on top by the language's own rules.

11.2 Naming collision — resolved by convention

Three canon terms now sit within one letter of each other. The following spellings and usages are binding:

TERM	REFERS TO	RULE
LOG	The unit of account	Always singular capital, no article. 1 LOG = 1 hour.
The LOG	The founding constitutional document	Always takes the definite article, capitalized.
LOGG	The language	Double G, no article. Written out in full — Language of Geb's Guild — on first reference in any document.

STANDING RISK — RECORDED

Spoken aloud, all three terms are near-identical. The full-form rule above is the safeguard. It is a convention, not a structural fix, and it depends on being enforced in every published document.

11.3 Open item created by this amendment

NEW OPEN ITEM — 9.13

Definition of "Guild." Bixxville OS is defined in canon as a hybrid union and chamber of commerce. "Guild" is introduced here for the first time and is not yet a defined canon term. Either it is defined — as a synonym for the network, as a body within it, or as the membership itself — or the full form is revised.

Orthography

AMENDMENT 002 · 2026-09-04 UTC

LOGG is written in two registers: Plain LOGG and Formal LOGG.

Plain LOGG is the primary register. It is what the OS speaks, what members learn first, and the default for all work. Formal LOGG is derived from it by five mechanical rules and is reserved for canon, contracts, published books, and ceremony.

A2.1 The design constraint

Every difference between the two registers must be a rule that applies across the whole language with no exceptions. A member learns one vocabulary plus a conversion table — never two vocabularies.

BINDING CONSTRAINT

If a word must be memorized separately in each register, the rule set has failed and must be revised rather than the word excepted. No exception lists.

A2.2 Register assignment

REGISTER	USED FOR
Plain LOGG	The OS interface, messages, notifications, contracts in working use, teaching materials, day-to-day work, all member-facing text. Learned first.
Formal LOGG	The constitution, canon documents, published books, certificates, ceremony, and any text that carries the visual link to the historical archive.

A2.3 The five conversion rules

Formal to Plain. Reverse them to go the other way. Each applies everywhere.

#	RULE	FORMAL	PLAIN
1	oe becomes u	Hoes, joe, moeschi, Boeki	hus, ju, mushi, buki
2	ie becomes i	mie, sie, die, Brief	mi, si, di, brif

#	RULE	FORMAL	PLAIN
3	Doubled letters reduce to single	kaa, guut, wees, sett	ka, gut, wes, set
4	c becomes k	Creol, Carriolse	kreol, kariolse
5	Nouns lose their capitals	die Kint, si Door	di kint, shi dor

A2.4 Held constant in both registers

CONSTANT	RULE AND REASON
sh	The sources give <i>si</i> , <i>sie</i> , and <i>shi</i> for the same word. LOGG fixes it as shi in both registers. Unambiguous to an English reader, and it separates the possessive from any other <i>si</i> .
The r is always written	Speakers dropped syllable-final /r/ from at least 1770, but every historical writer kept writing it. LOGG keeps it. Dropping it would collapse <i>dor</i> to <i>do</i> and <i>werk</i> to <i>wek</i> , creating collisions and severing the two registers. This is a deliberate etymological exception: spelling shows the r, speech does what speech does.
No diacritics	Nelson's 1936 notation (<i>ā ō ē ε ī ɔ</i>) is a linguist's transcription, not a writing system. Diacritics break in URLs, filenames, database fields, and on phone keyboards. LOGG has to live inside the OS.

A2.5 Plain LOGG — letters and sounds

The full system a member needs. One lesson.

LETTER	SOUND	EXAMPLE
a	as in <i>father</i>	kan, dat, han
e	as in <i>bet</i>	wes, ler, werk
i	as in <i>machine</i>	mi, di, shi
o	as in <i>go</i>	lo, ko, dor
u	as in <i>flute</i>	hus, ju, buki
j	as English y — never as in <i>jam</i>	ju is said "yoo"
g	hard, as in <i>go</i> — never as in <i>gem</i>	gras, gut
sh	as in <i>ship</i>	shi, shishi
w	as in <i>water</i>	wes, wak, wapi
All other consonants — b d f h k l m n p r s t v z — as in English.		

TEACHING NOTE — THE ONE TRAP

The letter **j** is the single place an English reader will go wrong. **ju** is "yoo," not "joo." This must be the first thing taught and the first thing corrected.

A2.6 Core lexicon — both registers

PRONOUNS

FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING	FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING
mie	mi	I, me, my	ons	ons	we, us, our
joe	ju	you	jender	jender	you all
hem	am	he, she, it	sender	sender	they, them

PARTICLES AND FUNCTION WORDS

FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING	FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING
a	a	past	die	di	the, that, it
kaa	ka	completed	deese	dese	this, these
sal	sa	future	een	en	a, one
lo	lo	in progress	sie	shi	his, her, its
le	le	habitual	na	na	in, at, to, on
no	no	not	voor	vor	for, in order to
da	da	emphasis	tee	te	until

VERBS

FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING	FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING
wees	wes	be	lees	les	read
hab	hab	have	leer	ler	learn, teach
kan	kan	can	skriev	skriv	write
kom	kom	come	verstaan	verstan	understand
doe	du	do	hoor	hor	hear

FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING	FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING
maak	mak	make	see	se	say
neem	nem	take	weet	wet	know
gloo	glo	believe	kik	kik	see, look

NOUNS

FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING	FORMAL	PLAIN	MEANING
Hoes	hus	house	Boeki	buki	book
Deer	der	door	Brief	brif	letter
Kint	kint	child	Werk	werk	work
Volk	volk	people	Dag	dag	day
Taal	tal	language	Stadt	stat	town
Man	man	man	Steen	sten	stone
Hogo	hogo	eye	Vier	vir	fire
Creol	kreol	creole	Pampuen	pampun	pumpkin

A2.7 Worked test

The same sentence in both registers. Every word maps by the five rules; no lookup is needed in either direction.

FORMAL Die Kint sender kaa leer voor lees die Boeki.

PLAIN Di kint sender ka ler vor les di buki.

DET child 3PL PRF learn FOR read DET book
 "The children have learned to read the book."

FORMAL Mie sal wis joe wapie joe kaa maak die Werk.

PLAIN Mi sa wis ju wapi ju ka mak di werk.

1SG FUT show 2SG where 2SG PRF make DET work
 "I will show you where you did the work."

A2.8 Recorded risks

RISK 1 — VOWEL LENGTH IS UNMARKED IN PLAIN

Rule 3 collapses doubled vowels, so Plain LOGG does not distinguish long from short vowels. No collisions have been found in the attested lexicon, but new coinages could create them. Every coinage must be checked against the Plain lexicon before adoption.

RISK 2 — PLAIN SPELLING DOES NOT MATCH THE ARCHIVE

A member fluent in Plain LOGG will not recognize words on sight in the 1770 or 1777 sources. Formal LOGG is the bridge, and BXV-LANG-000 remains the record of how the language was actually written. These are three distinct things and must not be conflated.

A2.9 Resolves

ITEM	DECISION	RESOLUTION
9.4	Orthography	Hybrid, two registers. Plain LOGG primary and phonemic; Formal LOGG derived by five rules. No diacritics.
9.8	Diminutive	Analytic klein only. The -tje ending is not admitted — the sources attribute it to white speech.
9.9	Comparison	Strict analytic — klein / mer klein / mest klein . The -ste superlative is not admitted, same reason.
9.6	Plural	sender particle only. The Dutch -s ending is not admitted, same reason.
9.7	Pronoun set	The -lie forms are not admitted. The sources attribute them to white speech and only sel survived to the 20th century.

A2.10 Open items after this amendment

ITEM	DECISION	STATUS
9.14	Register authority — when a Formal text and its Plain version disagree, which one governs	OPEN
9.5	TMA set — le or lo for habitual, and how to disambiguate lo progressive from lo future	OPEN
9.10	Word-formation rules for coining new vocabulary	OPEN
9.13	Definition of "Guild"	OPEN

BXV-LANG-000 · THE LANGUAGE OF THE NETWORK — SOURCE RECORD

Status: record only · no decisions adopted · append-only

Source: van Rossem & van der Voort, *Die Creol taal*, Amsterdam University Press, 1996

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